

Section 1: Planning, purpose and introduction. (8 marks)

Level 3	6–8 marks • There is a clear, well focused plan, appropriately designed to include aims or questions or hypotheses linked to the geographic purpose of the investigation. • The plan is based on an individual geographical topic or issue, which is accurately and appropriately defined and within a research framework. • There is a justification for the investigation provided in the introduction and valid contextualisation of fieldwork and research. • The location is precise and geo-located, using geo-spatial techniques, at appropriately different scales. • There is clear evidence of valid and individual literature research that defines and contextualises the investigation through an appropriate combination of wider geographical links, comparisons, models and theory.
Level 2	3–5 marks • There is a mostly clear plan, appropriately designed to include aims or questions or hypotheses linked to the geographic purpose of the investigation. • The plan is based on an individual geographical topic or issue, within a research framework, which is partially defined. • There is some justification for the investigation provided in the introduction and an attempt to contextualise the fieldwork and research. • The location is clear, using geo-spatial techniques, and at different scales. • There is some evidence of individual research that supports the investigation through an appropriate combination of wider geographical links, comparisons, models and theory.
Level 1	1–2 marks • There is a partial or incomplete attempt to include a plan with aims or questions or hypotheses which are not clearly linked to the geographic purpose of the investigation. • The plan is based on an individual geographical topic or issue, within a research framework, but definitions are incomplete or absent. • There is no justification for the investigation provided in the introduction and no meaningful attempt to contextualise the fieldwork and research. • The location is unclear with few relevant or appropriate geo-spatial techniques. • There is limited evidence of research that supports the investigation through wider geographical links, comparisons, models or theory.
0 marks	• No response or no response worthy of credit.